Varnis Valley Water Review 2024

This review summarises drinking-water supply in the Varnis valley, where the Lake Varnis Water Authority (the Authority) is the sole supplier.

Storage

At the end of 2023 the Lake Varnis reservoir held 412 million cubic metres. At the end of 2024 the Lake Varnis reservoir held 455 million cubic metres. The Brennick dam spillway upgrade was completed in 2024 at a cost of 14 million euros.

Supply

In 2024, 78 per cent of the Authority's supply came from the reservoir. The Orrin Point desalination plant produced 58 million cubic metres of drinking water in 2024. Groundwater recharge of the Tarrow aquifer reached 23 million cubic metres in 2024.

Demand

Average household water use fell to 96 litres per person per day in 2024. 40 per cent of households had a water meter in 2024. The Authority served 214,000 customer accounts in 2024.

Infrastructure

The Authority runs 9 treatment works. The Kessel treatment works has a capacity of 41 megalitres per day. The Holm Bridge treatment works treated 20 megalitres per day in 2024. The Authority replaced 85 kilometres of lead pipes in 2024.

Service quality

In 2024 the Authority met the drinking-water quality standard in 99.6 per cent of samples.